

RUNJI GAO

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EDUCATION

UCSD Rady School of Management

- PhD in Management

San Diego, CA

September 2026 - Now

Columbia University

- Statistics (M.A.)
- Cumulative GPA: 3.3/4.0

New York, NY

September 2025- May 2026

New York University

- Economics and Data Science (B.A.) | Minor: Psychology
- Cumulative GPA: 3.6/4.0

New York, NY

September 2021- May 2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Columbia Business School Computational Behavioral Science Lab (PI: Dr. Sandra Matz)

New York, NY

Research Assistant

April 2025 – May 2026

- Designed and optimized experimental protocols
- Co-hosting experiment sessions with PhD student via zoom sessions
- Managing experiment log and cleaning data for 300+ participants

Washington University in St. Louis Behavioral Economics Lab (PI: Dr. Leonard Green)

Remote

Research Assistant

October 2023 - Now

- Collaborating on the study design and programming the experiment on Qualtrics
- Performing statistical analyses of the experimental data obtained in R and Python
- Presenting results at lab meetings and assisting with manuscript preparation

NYU SPAM Lab (PI: Dr. Emily Balcetis) & Trope Lab (PI: Dr. Yaacov Trope)

New York, NY

Research Assistant

October 2023 - Now

- Assisting study design and programming the experiment on Qualtrics
- Cleaning, visualizing, and statistically analyzing experimental data
- Managing and supervising three research assistants on projects
- Composing grant proposals for Dean's Undergraduate Research Grants and other competitive funding

NYU Collective Cognition Lab (PI: Dr. Madalina Vlasceanu)

New York, NY

Research Assistant

October 2022 – May 2024

- Collaborated with PhD student on paper editing and manuscript preparation
- Implemented interactive experiments using JavaScript/HTML and cleaned collected data
- Composing grant proposals for research funding
- Created research stimuli materials using Photoshop and other online tools

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

- Berkebile-Weinberg, M., **Gao, R.**, Tang, R., & Vlasceanu, M. (2024). *How Internet Image Search Outputs Propagate Climate Change Sentiment and Can Stimulate Support for Climate Policy*. **Nature Climate Change**.
- Yeh, Y., **Gao, R.**, & Green, L. (in preparation). *Extending Analysis on a New Discounting Framework for Trade-offs Between Risk and Delay*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **Gao, R.**, Xiao, M., & Balcetis, E. (2025) *Superstars and Near Peers: Role Models and Me: Psychological Distance and Type of Advice*. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
- Xiao, M., **Gao, R.**, & Balcetis, E. (2024) *Superstars and Near Peers: Role Models and How They Motivate*. Oral presentation at the Society for the Psychological Study of Social Issues (SPSSI) Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

RESEARCH FUNDINGS & GRANTS

2024 Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund (DURF) \$1250
2024 Wasserman Center Internship Grant (WCIG) \$1200
2024 Dean's Undergraduate Conference Grant \$1000
2023 Dean's Undergraduate Conference Grant \$1000
2023 Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund (DURF) \$2250
2022 Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund (DURF) \$2000

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCES

AstraZeneca

Shanghai, China

Business Development & Venture Capital Intern

June 2025 - September 2025

- Modified and improved predictive models for vaccine market size and revenue forecasting
- Maintained and refined the market landscape of GLP drugs with proprietary databases and academic literature review
- Conducted internal research and knowledge sharing on AI-driven protein structure design
- Collected and summarized BD transaction data from South Korea and Australia to produce regional market overviews

Roland Berger

Remote

Management Consulting Intern

September 2023 – November 2023

- Assisted the project manager in crafting persuasive proposals and enhancing presentation materials
- Acquired pertinent data related to Electric Vehicles (E-vehicle) and Urban Planning
- Analyzed the insights gleaned from expert interviews
- Supervised a team of interns engaged in project work

IQVIA

Shanghai, China

Management Consulting Intern

June 2023 - September 2023

- Conducted comprehensive desk research to curate insights from open-source platforms and scholarly journals
- Formulated potential assessments and crafted data-driven presentations to facilitate marketing strategies for MNCs
- Cultivated data analysis proficiency, generating data visualizations using proprietary databases
- Utilized Excel for computing potential tender outcomes among MNCs and presented findings
- Initiated outreach to healthcare institutions through cold calls to amass data on vaccine supply
- Recorded expert interviews and compiled concise notes to synthesize and categorize critical information

AWARDS

2024 Myron Kove Research Scholar
2023 Dr. Dorothy Starr Research Scholar
2021 Josh Goldfaden Award

SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), German (Elementary)

Technical Skills: Qualtrics

Python data analysis (NumPy, Pandas, Sklearn, Matplotlib, Seaborn, SciPy); R data analysis

Python programming; Java (OOP, Data Structure); JavaScript; HTML

Basic machine learning methods

Other skills: Poster presentation

Microsoft office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, etc.)

Academic writing

Creating slides following storylines